

Seungmin Lee

slee76@nd.edu | 574-300-3160 | eatorange.github.io|
linkedin.com/in/seungmin-lee-2973993b | github.com/eatorange

PROFILE SUMMARY

Applied econometrician (Ph.D., Applied Economics) employing causal inference and machine learning in predictive models and policy-relevant evidence on household welfare, food security, and social safety net programs. Findings have informed policy discussions with USDA's Economic Research Service and the Institute for Research on Poverty and have been published in top-ranked field journals. Expertise in designing and evaluating randomized controlled trials, building predictive models from survey and administrative data, and collaborating across interdisciplinary teams.

EDUCATION

Ph.D. Applied Economics and Management

May 2024

Cornell University, Ithaca, NY, USA

Relevant Courses: Empirical Strategy for Policy Analysis, Dynamic Optimization, Applied Time Series Analysis

B.S. Mathematics and Economics with High Honors | 3.8/4.0

Dec 2014

University of Michigan in Ann Arbor, MI, USA

SPECIALIZED SKILLS

Technical: Microsoft Office, Stata, R, Python, MATLAB, Git, Qualtrics, SurveyCTO, ODK

Language: English, Korean (fluent), German (Basic)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Postdoctoral Research Associate, University of Notre Dame, Notre Dame, USA

Jun 2024 – (present)

- As lead author within a multi-PI research project, directed country selection, data collection, and analysis, and led manuscript writing for a study on the impacts of a payment-for-ecosystem-services program on deforestation and economic activity over a 12-year period in Uganda and Bolivia, incorporating remotely sensed data on forest cover, electricity, and building footprints.
- Designed and implemented lab-in-the-field experiments examining how participatory design shapes outcomes in community-led local development projects, covering 4,000 individuals in Nepal and 2,000 in Kenya (NSF-funded study: "Inequality, Participation, and the Design of Local Development Projects").

Graduate Research Assistant, Cornell University, Ithaca, USA

Oct 2019 – May 2024

- Developed a complementary food security measure using an applied econometric method and estimated long-term food security dynamics in the U.S., making the research published in a top field journal.
- Constructed a multidimensional household resilience measure using household survey data in Ethiopia, published in a top field journal.

Consultant, World Bank, Washington, D.C., USA

Aug 2016 - May 2018

- Programmed survey instruments and supervised data collection in a randomized control trial (RCT), analyzing causal effects of safety inspections on health facility quality in Kenya.
- Designed a follow-up data collection effort gathering mobile phone transaction data from households to identify ultra-poor households in Kenya using machine learning; the resulting dataset was later used in a paper published in a top general economics journal, in which I was acknowledged as a data contributor.

Research Analyst, Innovations for Poverty Action, New Haven, USA

Aug 2015 - July 2016

- Conducted econometric analyses with different regression models, explaining how different treatments and social networks affect households' hygienic latrine investment decisions in Bangladesh.
- Analyzed the effectiveness of seasonal migration in reducing poverty in rural Bangladesh and evaluated the best migration treatment among multiple treatments conducted in a randomized controlled trial.

Research Assistant, University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, USA

May 2013 – Dec 2014

- Analyzed datasets from published research and created do-files, explaining how rainfall shock in India affected Indian households' structures, including irrigated land area and village-level political governance.

Research Assistant, Deloitte Anjin LLC Financial Advisory Service, Seoul, Korea

Mar 2012 - Aug 2012

- Conducted market trend analyses and case studies on domestic and overseas office, retail, and other commercial real estate markets.
- Analyzed investment strategies and portfolios of major sovereign wealth funds and asset management firms.

Publications

- Seungmin Lee, Kibrom A. Abay, Christopher B. Barrett, and John Hoddinott. 2026. "Estimating Multidimensional Development Resilience." *Journal of Development Economics* 178 (January): 103583.
- Seungmin Lee, Christopher B. Barrett, John F. Hoddinott. 2023. "Food Security Dynamics in the United States: 2001-2017". *American Journal of Agricultural Economics* 1-24

AWARDS AND HONORS

- Excellence in Research, Pulte Institute for Global Development 2026
- George F. Warren Award (First Place), for the best graduate student research paper 2022
- James B. Angell Scholar & William J. Branstrom Freshman Prize 2010
- The President's Volunteer Service Award 2008

INITIATIVES AND LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

- Graduate and Professional Student Assembly Representative, Cornell University
- Co-mentor, The Structural Transformation of African Agriculture and Rural Spaces (STAARS), Cornell University
- Initiated and implemented a new program initiative to help broaden the cultural understanding of local Ghanaian students by coordinating 3 video conference sessions between the students and the University of Michigan Global Understanding class.

MEMBERSHIPS AND AFFILIATIONS

- Member, American Economic Association Since 2020
- Member, Agricultural and Applied Economics Association Since 2020
- Member, Northeastern Agricultural and Resource Economics Association Since 2025
- Member, Southern Economic Association Since 2025

SELECTED CONFERENCES

- International Conference on Empirical Economics 2026
- National Sustainability Society Annual Conference 2025, 2026
- Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting 2022, 2025, 2026
- Panel Study of Income Dynamics User Conference 2022, 2026
- FLARE Annual Meeting 2025
- Agricultural and Applied Economics Association (AAEA) Annual Meeting 2022, 2023, 2024
- USDA/ERS - University of Nebraska Food Security Symposium 2023
- International Conference of Agricultural Economists 2021